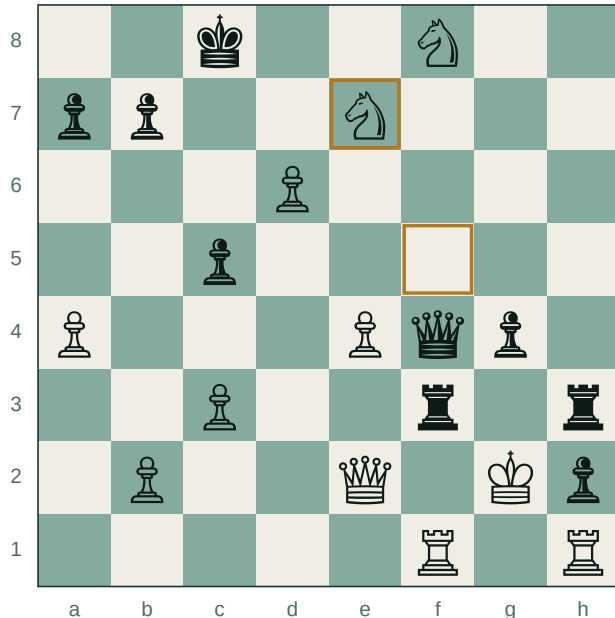


Exposed-king tactics: Black, move 35

Exposed-king tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 35.Ne7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35...Kb8 36. Rxf3 gxf3+ 37. Kxh3 fxe2

35...Kb8 The king moves from c8 to b8. Recorded reply: **36.Rxf3**.

36...gxf3+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From f3 it attacks king on g2 and queen on e2. Recorded reply: **37.Kxh3**.

37...fxe2 The pawn captures the queen on e2.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -6 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on g2. Geometrically undefended: knight on f8 and queen on e2. Check for tactical protection.